

tional tempo vans, minivans, often known as *erichis*. So, our team started to craft different solutions for different cities based on their unique transport ecosystem.”

Sanka says Rapido’s focus is on affordability, and it explores new vehicle segments to provide tailor-made solutions.

It is now looking at parking infrastructure solutions so that a single ticket on the Metro rail lets the commuter cover the last mile from train to home using some Rapido ride. Sanka says Rapido wants to leverage its large distribution network to expand into logistics. Rapido is also studying how people transport goods, especially in Tier II and III towns.

Rishikesh underscores the af-

fordability theme. “Our ultimate objective is to enable, in whatever way we can, mobility solutions that add value to our captains and consumers,” he says. “Rapido has always been in this unique position of being a low-cost player. We are already operationally profitable with our latest cab service offerings and are providing the lowest price for our cabs without discounts,” he says. In FY23, Rapido recorded ₹497 crore in revenue and ₹2,520 crore in GMV, according to the company.

Rapido’s focus on growth is centred around leveraging existing infrastructure to cater to more people without compromising on convenience or safety.

“We’ve come a long way, and the major factor that has continued to

sustain us is that we are working at the ground level to identify and understand the real problems affecting mobility. Solving the dilemma around convenience vs affordability is what we are all about,” says Rishikesh.

From facilitating a mere 500 rides a day to a staggering 1.5 million rides daily, Rapido’s meteoric rise is a testament to its ground-level understanding of real problems. “If the solution requires us to innovate in e-rickshaws, buses, bikes, etc., we will do exactly that. It’s about leveraging the existing infrastructure better—how we did with bike taxis,” says Guntupalli.[BT](#)

@PLidhoo

PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**



RAPIDO

CO-FOUNDERS (from left)

- PAVAN GUNTUPALLI
- RISHIKESH S.R.
- ARAVIND SANKA

KEY INVESTORS

Swiggy, TVS Motor Company, WestBridge Capital, Shell Ventures and Nexus Venture Partners

FUNDING

As of April 15, 2022, it had raised \$310.4 million in funding

FINANCIALS

In FY23, Rapido recorded ₹497 crore in revenue and ₹2,520 crore in GMV

WHAT MAKES IT COOL

Rapido understands the problem statement and has people on the ground who understand how to build a multi-modal transport solution that can help India move better